

theatre

Back to the Native

BANGALORE As far as theatre is concerned, the festive season has already begun. The Rang Sangeet Mahotsav, presented by Amol Palekar, will kick-start the theatre festival in Pune. With such festivals and retrospectives of Vijay Tendulkar, Badal Sircar and Ratan Thiyam as an impeccable medium, Palekar has been curating and paying tribute to the Indian theatre for the last three years now.

This year the focus is on the century-old tradition of Sangeet Natak, an art form which is still vibrant in Maharashtra and Karnataka. Leading theatre actor and director B. Jayashree's works—*Chitrapata*, *Karimayi*, and *Lakshapati* will also be a part of the festival.

The highlight of the season will be the premiere of two new productions—*Chandra Madhavi* in Marathi and *Girija Kalyana* in Kannada. From October 11 to 14 at the Y.B. Chavan Auditorium and the Balgandharva

Rangmandir, Pune.

Almost simultaneously, the Hindu Theatre Festival in Hyderabad will feature works by both newcomers as well as established theatre companies. But the biggest of them all is the 10-day-long Ranga Shankara Theatre Festival, which will see Naseeruddin Shah in *Jean Anouilh's Antigone*, directed by Satyadev Dubey, Neelam Mansingh Choudhury's new production in Punjabi *The Suit* and Dharamveer Bharati's *Andha Yug*, directed by Thiyam. Besides, there will be special performances by artists Revathy and Rehan Engineer to a smaller audience.

The festival also includes an academic section—a theatre and arts appreciation course facilitated by art historian Manu Chakravarty. Also a part of the festival is a Poet's Corner, organised by Jeet Thayil, with theatre songs in both English and Kannada.

Tickets are available at subsidised rates for students and artists. From October 20 to 28.

by **Nirmala Ravindran**

music festival

Classical Strains

DELHI The cultural calendar of the capital will be busy soon with the onset of SPIC MACAY'S (Society for Promotion of Indian Classical Music Amongst Youth) annual series which was started 25 years back to promote music among school and college students. Both maestros, upcoming artists and dancers reach out to the youth by organising lectures and concerts.

The Music in the Park series, also part of this effort, kicks off on October 14 with a Rudra veena recital by Bahauddin Dagar and then a scintillating performance by vocalist Kishori Amonkar of the Jaipur-Atrauli gharana. Rudra veena is one of the oldest Indian instruments, the history of which dates back at least 5,000 years. Vocalist Ashwini Bhide will perform on October 28 while flute maestro Hari Prasad Chaurasia will regale the audiences on November 17. One can also enjoy an eclectic performance by Shubha Mudgal followed by a violin recital by N. Rajam. Right weather to soak in some fine music. At Nehru Park.

by **S. Sahaya Ranjit**

SWEET SYMPHONY: Amonkar



art

A Full Canvas

DELHI National Gallery of Modern Art in association with the Japan Foundation presents *Vanishing Points: Contemporary Japanese Art*, an exhibition that presents works in a variety of media like paintings, sculptures, etchings and videos. Curated by Tadashi Kanai, associate professor, Shinshu University, it



A painting at the exhibition includes works by 10 Japanese artists—Noritoshi Hirakawa, Tomoaki Ishihara, Takehito Koganezawa, Saburo Muraoka, and others. From October 12 to November 11.

IMMORTAL: Bharati's Andha Yug

